MICRO-CREDENTIAL · COURSE SYLLABUS

Course Syllabus & Pacing Guide

Cohort 2 launches November 11, 2026

Free	≤12	~20	35	2–3
remote micro-credential	weeks to complete	hours of instruction	lessons in 5 modules	lessons per week

01 Program overview

The AI Leaders program is a free, remote micro-credential designed to upskill participants in AI leadership and prepare them to **land living-wage jobs**. The virtual course is built for busy students and professionals and is designed to be completed in 12 weeks or less, totaling approximately 20 hours of instruction.

02 Learning platform: plato

The course is hosted on plato, an open source, AI-powered microlearning platform.

FORMAT

Conversational lessons

Lessons are continuous, interactive conversations with an AI coach.

PACE

About 20 minutes each

Each lesson covers 2 to 4 learning objectives in about 11 exchanges.

ASSESSMENT

Mastery-based

The AI evaluates your text or image submissions and tracks progress toward a mastery-level exemplar.

03 Requirements & incentives

REQUIRED

WordPress Portfolio

All graduates build and showcase a WordPress-powered portfolio as proof of completion.

INCENTIVE

Top 40 Finalists

High-performing graduates seeking employment receive expert career coaching, letters of recommendation and direct connections to hiring employers. Finalists are chosen on the quality of their work and their community engagement.

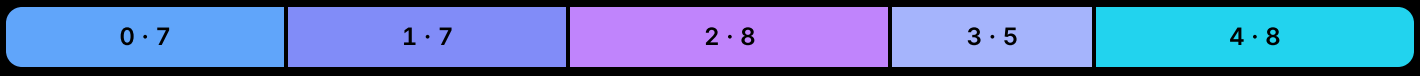
04 Six portfolio criteria

1. **Skillful AI use**
   Artifacts showing skillful generative and agentic AI use for efficiency, ideation, iteration or experimentation
2. **AI ethics**
   Concisely explains and demonstrates your personal approach to AI ethics
3. **Deployed WordPress site**
   Multiple pages using multiple WordPress design elements and features
4. **WordPress AI**
   Uses current WordPress AI capabilities
5. **About you**
   Personal introduction, resume, work artifacts and visuals demonstrating your skills and goals
6. **Professional design**
   Visuals, design and organization support your goals and align to professional standards in your field

Each criterion is equally weighted. Your portfolio needs to demonstrate all six clearly: not just touch them, but show evidence of skill and intentionality in each area.

05 Module breakdown & course outline

To finish comfortably within 12 weeks while managing a full schedule, aim to complete **2 to 3 lessons per week**.



Lessons per module, to scale (35 total).

MODULE 0

Foundations

7 lessons

Core professional and self-management skills.

- Professional Identity
- Tech Stack Fluency
- Organization
- Prioritization & Self Management
- Measuring Impact
- Digital Identity
- Digital Community

MODULE 1

AI Leadership

7 lessons

Using generative and agentic AI tools effectively.

- Generative AI Fundamentals
- Agentic AI Fundamentals
- Human in the Loop
- Efficiency
- Ideation, Experimentation & Iteration
- Agency & Adaptability
- Operationalizing Your Ethics

MODULE 2

WordPress

8 lessons

Technical setup and content creation for your portfolio.

- Account Setup and Norms
- Open Source Foundations
- WordPress Jobs
- WordPress and Me
- Deployment
- Content Development
- Style Customization
- AI Enablement

MODULE 3

Success Skills

5 lessons

Workplace dynamics and presentation.

- Living Wages
- Healthy Conflict
- Networking
- Storytelling & Presenting
- Digital Portfolio

MODULE 4

Job Placement

8 lessons

Actionable career strategies.

- Setup
- Resume
- Non-Negotiables
- Validated 50
- Submitted Three
- Reach Three
- Follow Up
- Feedback Loop

06 Strategies for success & pacing

01 Manage the AI coach

The plato AI coach aims to guide you to the lesson's target exemplar in around 11 exchanges. Keep your prompts focused on the specific learning objectives to move through lessons efficiently.

02 Prioritize the technical portfolio

Your final WordPress site is your primary proof of capability. Apply concepts from the WordPress module early, and dedicate time to iteratively refine your deployment, custom styling and content structure.

03 Engage for the Top 40

Because the Top 40 spots offer significant career coaching and networking benefits, focus on your portfolio's quality and participate actively in the community from week one.